NORTHGATE UNIVERSITY
DEPARTMENT OF URBAN SYSTEMS

To the Graduate Admissions Committee

Re: Priya Bhattacharya, application to the MSc in Urban Systems

Dear colleagues,

I have known Priya Bhattacharya for three years, first as a student in my Urban Economics seminar and later as a research assistant in the Urban Data Lab. She is among the strongest undergraduates I have supervised in the past decade.

Priya combines quantitative discipline with an unusual feel for how cities actually work. In the lab she rebuilt our parcel level land use dataset almost single handed, and she documented the work so carefully that the next cohort could pick it up without a handover meeting.

I recommend her without reservation for the MSc in Urban Systems. The programme’s emphasis on evidence led planning is exactly what her undergraduate work has prepared her for.

Sincerely,
Aurelio Castellan
Professor of Urban Systems
Northgate University

Date: 12 October 2026